ACTIVITY 1: INCIDENT REPORT BY ELLA SIGUE

SCENARIO B – RANSOMWARE NOTICE

Incident Report

Organization	HGH Centre
Department	Security Operations Center (SOC)
Section	Incident Response

Initial Incident Details	
Incident Raised By	Employee name not provided (Department not provided)
Incident Received By	SOC Analyst
Report Date	21-Oct-2026
IT Service Disrupted	Employee computer and access to files

Detailed Incident Information			
Incident Date	21-Oct-2026 (reported as occurring this morning)	**Incident Hour**	Exact time unknown
Incident Number	IR-002	**Incident Category**	High
Was the SLA Breached?	To be determined	**Duration of Interruption**	Ongoing

Incident Description
An employee attempted to open a spreadsheet file. Instead of the file, a black screen appeared with white text stating that all files were encrypted and Bitcoin must be paid to recover them. The desktop wallpaper had also changed. This is consistent with a suspected ransomware incident.

Incident Intake Questions and Answers	
QUESTION	**ANSWER**
Q1. What is your name and department?	Name and department were not provided in the scenario. Obtain the employee's name and department during intake.
Q2. What device or system is affected? (hostname / IP)	The computer used to open the spreadsheet is affected. Hostname and IP address are unknown and should be collected by IT.
Q3. What did you notice, and when exactly did it start?	After attempting to open a spreadsheet this morning, a black screen appeared with a ransom message saying files were encrypted and Bitcoin was required. The desktop wallpaper also changed. Exact start time is unknown.
Q4. Did you click any links or open any attachments?	The employee attempted to open a spreadsheet file. The scenario does not specify whether it came from an email, link, or attachment.
Q5. Is the device still connected to the network?	Not stated in the scenario. Confirm immediately; if it is connected, isolate it from the network according to incident-response procedures.

Q6. Has anyone else in your team noticed anything similar?	Not stated. Ask the team and IT to check for similar symptoms or ransom notices on other devices.

Business Impact
Potential loss of access to business files, disruption of work, and possible spread of ransomware to shared drives or other connected systems. The scope of encryption and any data exposure are not yet known.

Corrective Actions Taken / Recommended
Escalate to the incident response team immediately. Isolate the affected device from wired and wireless networks according to policy. Do not pay the ransom or delete files, and do not attempt ad hoc cleanup. Preserve the ransom note and system state, then have IT/security investigate, contain the incident, and determine recovery from trusted backups.

Evidence to Collect
Photograph or capture the ransom message and changed wallpaper; record the time observed; collect the affected device's hostname, IP address, and user; preserve the spreadsheet and its source; gather relevant endpoint, antivirus/EDR, email, and network logs; identify affected files, shared drives, and other potentially impacted devices.

Status
Under Investigation. Suspected threat: ransomware / file encryption. Confirm the scope of affected systems and determine whether data was accessed or exfiltrated.

SCENARIO C – UNAUTHORIZED ACCESS

Incident Report

Organization	HGH Centre
Department	Security Operations Center (SOC)
Section	Incident Response

Initial Incident Details	
Incident Raised By	Employee name not provided (Department not provided)
Incident Received By	SOC Analyst
Report Date	21-Oct-2026
IT Service Disrupted	Employee company account and potentially the office laptop

Detailed Incident Information			
Incident Date	21-Oct-2026 (alert refers to approximately 3:00 AM the previous night)	**Incident Hour**	Approx. 3:00 AM
Incident Number	IR-003	**Incident Category**	High
Was the SLA Breached?	To be determined	**Duration of Interruption**	Ongoing

Incident Description
The employee received an email from IT stating that their account had been accessed from an IP address in Romania at approximately 3:00 AM the previous night. The employee was asleep at that time. They have not changed their password in two years and use the same password on multiple websites.

Incident Intake Questions and Answers	
QUESTION	**ANSWER**
Q1. What is your name and department?	Name and department were not provided in the scenario. Confirm these details during intake.
Q2. What device or system is affected? (hostname / IP)	The company account is affected and may be accessed through the employee's office laptop. The device hostname and IP are unknown. The login alert identified a source IP associated with Romania; obtain the exact IP from the alert or authentication logs.
Q3. What did you notice, and when exactly did it start?	The employee received an IT email reporting account access from Romania at approximately 3:00 AM the previous night. The employee was asleep and did not recognize the login.
Q4. Did you click any links or open any attachments?	The scenario does not indicate that the employee clicked a link or opened an attachment. The employee reported receiving and reading the IT security alert. The password has been reused across multiple websites for about two years.

Q5. Is the device still connected to the network?	The scenario does not state whether the office laptop is still connected. Confirm the laptop's status and check whether the account was accessed from other devices.
Q6. Has anyone else in your team noticed anything similar?	Not stated. Ask the team to report unusual login alerts or account activity and check for related alerts.

Business Impact
Possible compromise of the employee's company account, exposure of confidential company information, unauthorized account changes, and access to other systems if the reused password works elsewhere.

Corrective Actions Taken / Recommended
Escalate to the SOC/IT security team. Verify the alert using authentication logs and confirm the source IP, timestamp, and timezone. Revoke active sessions, reset the password using a trusted device, and enable multifactor authentication (MFA). Review recent account activity and check for unauthorized changes. Change the reused password on other services as well, using unique passwords for each account.

Evidence to Collect
Original IT security alert; exact source IP address and geolocation result; login timestamp and timezone; authentication and MFA logs; affected account and device details; recent sign-in history; and any unauthorized account changes or suspicious activity.

Status
Under Investigation. Suspected threat: unauthorized account access, potentially involving a compromised or reused password.